

Unit 1.2 Vocabulary

Program Function & Purpose · Study Sheet



Know These Cold

Every word on this sheet can appear on the AP exam, and you'll use them in your Create Performance Task written response. Fold the sheet to hide the definitions and quiz yourself!

Program

A collection of program statements that performs a specific task when run by a computer. Also called **software**.

e.g., A weather app, a calculator, a video game

Code segment

A collection of program statements that is **part of** a program.

e.g., The 4 lines that calculate a tip inside a restaurant app

Purpose

Why a program exists: the problem it solves or the creative interest it pursues.

e.g., "Helps students find clubs that interest them"

Function

What a program does when it runs.

e.g., "Sorts clubs by meeting day"

Behavior

How a program functions during execution; often described by how a user interacts with it.

e.g., "When the user taps a club, its details appear."

Input

Data **sent to** a computer for processing — from a user, a sensor, or another program.

e.g., Typing a city name; a GPS location; a photo

Output

Data **sent from** a program to a device: text, visuals, audio, or tactile.

e.g., A map on screen; a spoken direction; a vibration

Event

An action that supplies input data to a program.

e.g., A click, a key press, a swipe, a timer running out

Event-driven programming

Program statements run when **triggered** by an event, not in a set order.

e.g., `ON buttonClick("submit")` code waits for a click

Sensor

A device that measures the physical world and sends that data as input.

e.g., Thermometer, motion detector, heart-rate monitor

Tactile output

Output the user can **feel**.

e.g., A phone buzzing; a controller rumbling

User interface

The screens, buttons, and controls a user interacts with.

e.g., The buttons and text boxes on a sign-up screen

Don't Mix These Up!

- **Purpose vs. Function:** purpose = WHY it exists; function = WHAT it does.
- **Input vs. Event:** every event supplies input, but not every input is an event (a sensor reading every minute is input; a click is an event).
- **Event vs. Output:** the event causes code to run; the output is the result.



Exam tip:

If an answer choice describes a **feature** ("it shows a graph"), it's a function — not the purpose. The purpose names a problem or need for people.